

Class Notes: Phylum Platyhelminthes

Animal Kingdom • PU-I Biology • Class Notes

Body Plan and Organisation

Commonly called flatworms due to dorso-ventrally flattened bodies; bilaterally symmetrical, triploblastic, acoelomate, organ level of organisation. Nutrition is parasitic (endoparasites) with hooks and suckers present, or nutrients absorbed directly from the host.

Parasitic Adaptations and Examples

Excretion through specialised flame cells/solenocytes/protonephridia, which aid osmoregulation and excretion. Reproduction sexual and asexual (fission); Platyhelminthes are hermaphrodites with internal fertilisation and development consisting of several larval stages; some show high regeneration capacity. Examples: Taenia (tapeworm, parasite in pigs and humans), Fasciola (liver fluke, parasite in goat/sheep), Dugesia (Planaria, aquatic free-living).